

ERIK LINDQUIST

Principal AI Product Manager — Decision Intelligence

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SUMMARY

Builds decision intelligence as a closed loop, not as a model. Ships AI inside regulated institutions with no procurement cycle — in-house models, existing governance, no new data crossings. Defines what the system must satisfy before it exists, then proves the definition with a running instance.

Twenty years applying rules written by someone else — statute, case law, department policy — accountable for every application of them, on a clock, with incomplete information. Then a rebuild: degree and state teaching licence (2018), software engineer (2019), product manager (2021). Now writing the frameworks other people work inside.

The Operational AI Framework — ingest, AI transform, human decision, feedback loop — is in its second production instance at WGU, instrumenting the student lifecycle from first contact through graduation.

THE PIPELINE, END TO END

Genesys transcripts and sentiment → joined in the data lake → scored by three in-house AI tools → surfaced for review and completed as an observation in ServiceNow → back to the lake

One loop, closed. Unstructured voice becomes structured evidence in the lake; the transform scores it; the visualization layer puts that score in front of a human; ServiceNow executes what the human decides; the outcome returns to the lake as a label. Every human decision improves the next machine decision as a byproduct of work already required.

Banner I&O runs alongside it — an on-premise Oracle student information system supporting performance assessment, linked to the loop and deliberately kept separate. Improvement work there is done in partnership with the platform team lead.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Product Manager Western Governors University Oct 2024 – Present

- **Eliminated sampling.** Took enrollment call-review coverage from ~5% to 100% at flat headcount — Genesys transcripts with sentiment analysis, and QA observations performed in ServiceNow. The assignment was 10%; the answer was to stop sampling altogether. Established the Operational AI Framework — ingest, AI transform, human decision, feedback loop, machine-to-machine and unattended — which is what made it possible.
- **Ingest at the source.** Genesys call transcripts land in the data lake as the pipeline's raw input, making unstructured voice a queryable asset for the first time and removing sampling as a design constraint.
- **Decision surfaces over raw output.** Built the visualization layer that turns lake data into something a reviewer can act on, so the machine's contribution is sequencing and evidence rather than a verdict.
- **Closed the loop with the delta.** Machine-to-human scoring agreement moved from 60% to 80%+ by making the gap between machine and human scores the training signal — every coaching evaluation doubles as a label, and the queue improves without anyone doing additional work.
- **Wrote the human-machine contract first.** Machine scores are non-determinative by definition: never admissible in performance evaluation, only in sequencing which calls a human reviews. Set at launch rather than after objection, and the reason the platform was adopted rather than resisted.
- **ServiceNow as the execution layer.** Observations for thirteen user groups run in the UQA app in ServiceNow. Twelve of those groups had the tool and nothing to put through it — no transcripts, no evaluation process, no way to complete a review. Built the missing half for enrollment. Genesys sentiment and Genesys transcripts already existed and were consumed separately — sentiment by the enrollment team, transcripts by the QA coaches, neither seeing the other. Joining them in the data lake, under its existing security guarantees, produced something scorable for the first time; the three in-house AI tools scored it against the QA rubrics and the observation completes in ServiceNow. An executed workflow now produces telemetry instead of a closed ticket. The mentoring organisation is the second of the thirteen.
- **Banner I&O.** Integration and operations on the on-premise Oracle student information system supporting performance assessment, in partnership with the platform team lead — linked to the loop and kept separate from it.
- **Architecture as governance.** Composed the platform from three institutional AI capabilities already in service and already cleared by security — a business rules engine, machine learning models, and natural language processing — applying the QA team's existing rubrics as the scoring standard and the training signal. No new ingress or egress, no new processor, no vendor review, and the only incremental cost was compute time. The second instance now extends to the mentoring organization on the same architecture at no added risk surface.

- **Defined requirements instead of receiving them.** Produced the specification artifact for an AI platform vendor engagement: roughly 4,000 of the institution's own prospective-student decision nodes mapped to next-best-action on 100% synthetic data — zero disclosure exposure, and the institution setting the terms.
- **Business case and ROI.** Authored the case valuing avoided hiring at approximately \$660K over a rolling five years. Separately eliminated a 5.5-minute manual step from an ~11-minute per-call process, cutting about 45% from the time to complete an observation and meeting the original 10% coverage target on automation alone, before any AI screening applied.
- **Standards that outlive the project.** Wrote the engineering standards the team now builds under: validation is enforced on the server, untrusted integrations develop against local stand-ins until security review clears them, and point-in-time data always renders with its date. Built a capacity-recovery diagnostic that surfaces unowned, undocumented and stale work before it eats the team.

Product Manager Acima / Upbound 2021 – 2024

- **Generative-AI underwriting.** Directed a generative-AI assessment and categorization tool that underwrote individual transactions granularly, expanding the range of financial products the company could offer — a system that scored so a human could decide.
- **16-person delivery.** Led a 16-person development team through an overhaul of the servicing platform across UI/UX and backend servicing processes.
- **SOX at volume.** Rebuilt the accounting methodology to SOX audit compliance across 100,000+ daily financial transactions.

Software Engineer Acima / Upbound 2019 – 2021

- Built and maintained a B2B contract origination platform serving 10,000+ daily users, accountable for performance and scalability.
- Developed RESTful APIs and third-party integrations across B2B and B2C origination; defined requirements, timelines, and delivery with cross-functional teams.

Middle School Teacher — Biology & Earth Science Alpine School District 2018

- Utah-licensed in biology and earth science. Designed assessments that measured what a student actually knew — including a rocket lab where students estimated an altitude they could never reach and reported honest error bars with it.

Police Commander Murray City Corporation 1997 – 2017

- **Trained the decision, not only made it.** Field Training Officer, then Rapid-response Training Officer — twenty years transferring judgment to other officers under real consequence. The same practice as mentoring product managers, at higher stakes.
- **Command.** Commanded a 16-person tactical team and an 11-person investigative division.

EDUCATION

MBA, IT Management — Western Governors University, expected Aug 2027

BS, Biology Education — Utah Valley University, 2018

SKILLS

Decision intelligence feedback-loop architecture · human-in-the-loop design · model-to-human calibration · next-best-action modelling · synthetic data generation · agent orchestration

Enterprise platforms ServiceNow workflow and automation · Genesys contact centre · Banner I&O on on-premise Oracle · data lake ingest and modelling · visualization and reporting layers · AWS · SQL

Product strategy and roadmapping across domains · steering committees and stakeholder alignment · discovery in ambiguity · business-case and ROI modelling · evaluation design · executive narrative · agile delivery · mentoring product managers

Regulated FERPA-governed data · data classification · in-house-model architecture · security-review sequencing · provenance, licensing and disclosure discipline

Technical Python · JavaScript · Ruby on Rails · Elixir / Phoenix LiveView · D3 / SVG · PostgreSQL · SQL · Git · CI/CD · Vitest · RSpec